2.2 Asset Organization

Pipeline assets can be placed inside an application in one of three locations: `app/assets`, `lib/assets` or `vendor/assets`.

- `app/assets` is for assets that are owned by the application, such as custom images, JavaScript files or stylesheets.
- `lib/assets` is for your own libraries' code that doesn't really fit into the scope of the application or those libraries which are shared across applications.
- `vendor/assets` is for assets that are owned by outside entities, such as code for JavaScript plugins and CSS frameworks. Keep in mind that third party code with references to other files also processed by the asset Pipeline (images, stylesheets, etc.), will need to be rewritten to use helpers like `asset_path`.

If you are upgrading from Rails 3, please take into account that assets under `lib/assetsor` `vendor/assets` are available for inclusion via the application manifests but no longer part of the precompile array. See Precompiling Assets for guidance.

2.2.1 Search Paths

When a file is referenced from a manifest or a helper, Sprockets searches the three default asset locations for it.

The default locations are: the `images`, `javascripts` and `stylesheets` directories under the `app/assets` folder, but these subdirectories are not special - any path under `assets/*` will be searched.
For example, these files:

```
app/assets/javascripts/home.js
lib/assets/javascripts/moovinator.js
vendor/assets/javascripts/slider.js
vendor/assets/somepackage/phonebox.js
```

would be referenced in a manifest like this:

```
//= require home
//= require moovinator
//= require slider
//= require phonebox
```

Assets inside subdirectories can also be accessed.

```
app/assets/javascripts/sub/something.js
```

is referenced as:

```
//= require sub/something
```

You can view the search path by inspecting `Rails.application.config.assets.paths` in the Rails console.
Besides the standard `assets/*` paths, additional (fully qualified) paths can be added to the pipeline in`config/application.rb`. For example:

```
config.assets.paths << Rails.root.join("lib", "videoplayer", "flash")
```

Paths are traversed in the order they occur in the search path. By default, this means the files in `app/assets` take precedence, and will mask corresponding paths in `lib` and `vendor`.
It is important to note that files you want to reference outside a manifest must be added to the precompile array or they will not be available in the production environment.